

**Medford School Committee
Regular Meeting - March 9, 2020
Council Chambers - 7:00PM**

Present: Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Ms. Graham, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. McLaughlin, Ms. Mustone, Mayor Lungo-Koehn, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Ms. Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Dr. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson, and Student Representative Isabelle DeSouza.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:10 pm

Approval of Minutes of February 24, 2020 - Motion to approve by Ms. Graham, Seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll Call Vote: 7-0 Affirmative 0 negative, Motion passes

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve by Mr. Ruseau, Seconded by Ms. /Kreatz - Roll Call Vote 7-0 Affirmative 0 - negative, Motion passes

Report of Secretary - No Report

Report of Committees:

Curriculum Subcommittee - 2.26.20 - Ms. Van der Kloot made report - Ms. Graham and I were present at the meeting. Ms. Mustone was absent. Mr. Ruseau was in attendance along with Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Dr. Cushing, and Ms. Michelle Ciccilo. Ms. Rachel Perry made a presentation which proposed additions to the middle school health curriculum to align Medford Public Schools with national standards. This addition will add in sexual health, via The Michigan Model. The State standards are not out, so Medford has to follow the Federal ones. To that end, I would need to hire (1) full- time health teacher. Parents would receive an opt-out form. We do recognize the scheduling issues, for example, IEP students miss health. We do need to be in line with national standards. Ms. Van der Kloot - I make a motion that the school committee adopt Growing Up and Staying Healthy with Supplements.

Ms. McLaughlin - Is there a special education piece? Ms. Perry - We are looking at The Michigan Model and Flash for special education Ms. McLaughlin - What about EL? Ms. Perry - we would have to adapt for EL of course. We have a lot of work ahead. Mayor - I would like to see the curriculum before I vote on it. I would like to see the content. Ms. Perry - I will get you a copy. Ms. Van der Kloot - should I withdraw motion or lay on the table? Ms. Graham - Ms. Perry has a lot of work to do but is it on hold? Ms. Van der Kloot - Mayor does not feel comfortable voting without seeing the curriculum. Mr. Ruseau - We all received The Michigan Model folder. This is a vote for providing cover to our staff. We are forbidden by law not to provide this information to our students. I'm prepared to vote for it now. We are far off the national scale. Students need to know the facts of life, whatever you call it. I do not want to

wait. Ms. McLaughlin - this is an important topic but we need to know what is included in the curriculum. Motion by Ms. Van der Kloot to lay on table for 2 weeks, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin, with agreement that Ms. Perry will provide the curriculum content to the School Committee, Motion passes.

Rules, Policy, & Equity Subcommittee - 3.3.20 - Per Mr. Ruseau, the Committee met to rule on how to add an item to the agenda for the School Committee. We composed a specific procedure for adding an item. I will assume that you all read them. However, I would like to add an amendment “this procedure aims to provide an answer to this question” I make a motion to approve this as a rule for the School Committee with a slight change to the why. Steps for members to add to the agenda, with the how to and who to send to, as well as why we need this procedure. Ms. Kreatez - Would we follow these for subcommittee minutes for agenda? Ms. Van der Kloot - I have a timeline question, as well as, did the subcommittee approve? My concern is that 2 business days may not be feasible for the school administration. They are juggling a lot of balls in the air. I would ask the Superintendent what sort of timeline would be reasonable? Superintendent - I feel (4) days is a good time frame, as we meet every (2) weeks. If you want to go ahead and then review it again in (6) months? Mr. Ruseau - All of these procedures are not perfect. We can just head back into the subcommittee if they don’t work. Ms. Kreatez - Who would we send agenda items too for now? Superintendent - myself and/or the Mayor. Ms. McLaughlin - Maybe it would be good to discuss in this subcommittee when a pressing issue arises? Mayor - like Coronavirus? Ms. McLaughlin - Yes. Should we include it in the rule/policy? Mayor - In an emergency, the chair can take it under suspension. Mr. Ruseau - We just provided a way to build out the agenda. Ms. Van der Kloot - I appreciate the work. The Superintendent is willing to try. I make a motion to increase it to (3) days. Seconded by Ms. Kreatez. All in favor - Paper passes. Mr. Ruseau - We could table it until the next meeting, so members can really read it. Ms. Van der Kloot - Motions to table it and seconded by Mr. Ruseau - Paper is tabled. Mr. Ruseau - I make a motion to table the policy review as well. Seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Paper is tabled.

Committee of the Whole - Wages and High School Tour - 3.4.20 - Mayor Lungo-Koehn - We visited different areas of the high school building, noting places that could use fresh paint and the addition of ceiling tiles. The locker rooms are being re-done by the Vocational School. Motion by Ms. McLaughlin to request a Committee of the Whole Meeting with the newly formed MHS vision committee. Seconded by Ms. Kreatez - Motion passes. In addition, minimum wages in schools were discussed with students and employees. Motion to approve by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to approve the wages. Roll Call Vote - (7) in the affirmative and (0) in the negative. Paper passes.

Community Participation

Maureen Ronayne - wanted to speak about Dyslexia. She has a third grader who required special education services. Thank you for your help with this. She advocates for an Ad Hoc Committee for Dyslexia to identify needs to close the gap in one year. We need a Dyslexia Protocol throughout the whole district, with age appropriate evaluations to measure progress. The statistics at the end of 3rd grade that can not read are unacceptable and it continues on a downward slope throughout the remainder of school. We need to expand to the older students.

There is a presentation at the Winchester Library on March 21st about Dyslexia. Ms. Van der Kloot would like a copy of Ms. Ronayne statement to take under advisement. Thank you for acknowledging what the district has done. Ms. McLaughlin - I make a motion to send this to the Special Education Subcommittee. Seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Motion passes

Ilene Lerner from Safe Medford - had questions about the MHS Vision Committee. Why was it not publicized to apply? Why are there only white people appointed to the committee? I have heard, appointees had a background in construction, but could we add more members so our whole community is represented? Ms. McLaughlin - The applications were blind. Clearly, we have work to do to clarify it and reach out to all stakeholders in the community. We need to be proactive in the future. Superintendent - These applications were collected late last year. (42) applicants in total, a number with construction experience. It was a blind, voluntary application process. We definitely realize that we need to be more pro- active and reach out to our diverse groups including NAACP and members of the West Medford Community Center, as well as, many other members that make up our community. The Mayor will add members. Ms. McLaughlin - We do apologize for this!

Mayor - we will now revert to the regular order of business.

VII. Report of Superintendent

Superintendent's Updates and Comments:

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent made the official announcement that Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell would be retiring this June, after 45 years of outstanding & dedicated service to the Medford Public Schools. Diane's background is elementary education and special education and has been the administrator of numerous educational grants. She began her career in Medford teaching at the Dame Elementary School. Later, she taught at the Curtis Tufts and Medford High School. Moving into administration, Diane served as the Professional Development Coordinator and the Title I Director. 14 years ago she was appointed Assistant Superintendent for Elementary Education and 2 years ago was elevated to Associate Superintendent. When I first arrived in Medford, Diane opened her arms to me and shared her wealth of information, while providing guidance and advice, when needed. I quickly learned that Diane was an integral key in how the Medford Public School community was running so smoothly and working collaboratively together. Her knowledge is something that cannot be replaced. To say she will be greatly missed, is an understatement. I know I speak for everyone, when I say, we wish her nothing but the best in her retirement. We thank her husband Jack, along with her children and grandchildren for allowing us to have her as a part of our family for so long. Ms. Caldwell - It has been my honor to work for the students of the Medford Public Schools. Ms. McLaughlin - Ms. Caldwell has been a constant for our children all these years! We all appreciate your service. Ms. Van der Kloot - I add my sincere thanks, especially these last 2 years of your consistency in helping with the new Superintendent's transition. You are something very, very special. Thank you so much. Ms. Kreatz - Thank you and congratulations. Mayor - Congratulations! Enjoy! But we know we have you until then!

Regarding the Coronavirus, our custodians are disinfecting the schools daily. We have hired a private company to come in and do a deep disinfection of our schools and our Director of Health Services Toni Wray has been working closely with MaryAnn O'Connor from the Board of Health. As we have all been saying, please wash your hands. For any new developments, please know, it will be posted to the city and school websites.

The Superintendent thanked the Mayor and her Beautification Committee who worked on enhancing the entrance to Medford High School. She discussed the Welcoming Library, which will visit all schools, promoting culture for all children in school libraries. She commended the students who participated in the Region IV Science Fair at Tufts, all of the winter athletes and the GBL All Stars. Lastly, she reminded everyone of upcoming events: Middle School Lottery, the Transition Fair, the Curious George Character Breakfast and the next Building Bridges to Kindergarten presentation.

Ms. McLaughlin - Can it be clarified when the outside cleaners will come in? Mr. McLaughlin - Deep cleaning was unable to take place right away due to no availability. Deep cleaners will be in on March 18th. In the meantime, we have been spraying down everything with disinfectant in all the schools with this mist. Ms. McLaughlin - Is there soap in all the bathrooms? Mr. McLaughlin - Yes, and we have (30) cases in storage and I have ordered (10) more cases. Ms. Van der Kloot - Do we have a proactive plan for Covid-19? What would we do if we had to close the schools? Superintendent - tomorrow is our Administrative Development Day, and we will be working on a plan. Besides maybe homework packets and having parents read with their child, we will also discuss food. Some of our students are relying on 2 meals a day for food. We plan to make sure the pantry at Medford High School is filled so students can take home more items. We will discuss how to supply food to our families. Ms. Caldwell - we have sent out a message to our principals, asking what would you send home? We will be discussing the use of Google classroom, and how to get technology out to our students in need. Mayor - We are hosting emergency planning meetings including (police, fire, EMS, DPW, Council on Aging, Tufts University, and schools) and develop organizational charts. We intend to cross train staff. MaryAnn O'Connor and Toni Wray developed the FAQ segment for our websites. Ms. Graham - do we even know what our families do and don't have access too? Do they have access to cell phones, internet, chrome books, etc? How would we deploy technology if needed? Regarding the food security task force - do we know who depends on us for food? As parents we are not necessarily trained to teach our children. When building your plan, think about those things and then tell the community about the plan. Toni Wray - we refer to the CDC guidelines daily. Mr. Ruseau - at our next mtg, if we need school committee votes to implement plans, they should be presented at the next meeting. For example, paying teachers for 2-4 weeks. Can we front load so we can address them. Has the State indicated any assistance for these issues? Mayor - I will check with the state delegation. Should we have to close schools, we would do so following CDC guidelines and recommendations. Ms. Van der Kloot - teachers would be paid, per their contract. Mr. Ruseau - certainly we would pay them, but we might have to have them work for more days than contracted for. Ms. Van der Kloot - we are blessed we have not used a lot of days as yet. Ms. McLaughlin - the safety team meeting is scheduled for April 28th. This has been in the works for months. Safety is important for all of our students. Ms. Kreatz - the FAQ were very useful.

Recommendation to Approve 2020-2021 School Year Calendar - Ms. Caldwell - Labor Day is late this year. Motion to approve by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Cancellation of International Trip to France April 2020 - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli and Ms. Marie Nyland - With the advent of this virus and with advice of the federal government and Governor Baker, we have been advised to cancel international travel. The safety and health of our Medford public school students & staff is our top priority/ Ms. Nyland did so much work on this, great disappointment for her and all the students. With great sadness we recommend this to the committee. Ms. Kreatz - this is so unfortunate especially for the seniors, but the safety and well being of our students is our top priority. Maybe we could host a nice cultural event here? Ms. Van der Kloot - did all students buy cancellation insurance for any reason? Dr. Ricciardelli - Yes, but airfare is separate. Ms. Nyland - I will check to see if Delta will provide a voucher for the students. Ms. Van der Kloot - Maybe they could do the trip in summer instead? Ms. Nyland - Are seniors usually leave June 1st, so they no longer would be our students. Staff would not want to use their summer time. If it was mostly juniors, we would have gone in September, but it is majority seniors. A shame that this ever happened. Mr. Bob Green - 36 Ridgeway Rd - Thank you Dr. Ricciardelli and Ms. Nyland for all the work they put into this trip. Trip cost = \$3100. Insurance states it would refund - 50% , which sounds good, but it is only \$1,050, because it doesn't include the flight. The travel agency makes a nice penny from this. We should ask the agency for \$2,050 per person. Since the Governor said no trips abroad. Could the Governor pressure the travel agency? Or maybe the agency could offer another trip for the money? Dr. Ricciardelli - he is correct. 50% of tour costs does not include plane fare. But we can not wait any longer as we are 31 days out as it is. Mr. Ruseau - the insurance costs 10% of the total cost - so \$100 to get \$1000 back - Is there any other game in town? Could you do better with a different agency? Dr. Ricciardelli - it is not a great policy. A number of Superintendents are struggling with reimbursement. Some are getting less or none at all. I would like to think there will be some movement on this. If we wait any longer, less reimbursement. Mr. Ruseau - the policy doesn't exist to cancel after 31 days? Ms. Nyland - we probably should have really looked at the agency's policy, but this has never happened. I always get travel insurance for plane fare. I am hoping Delta will issue a voucher. Mr. Green - A voucher for plane fare would be good. Good will would go a long way here. Mayor - We should have Mr. Greenspan take a look at the policy. Ms. Graham - on the airfare topic, a lot of tour companies go through a process, so not sure what flight is actually worth as tour company packages are different than just making your own reservations for flight/hotel - we should, as a committee, re visit our field trip policy But we should speak to Atty Greenspan about the financial loss to our families. I make a motion to give Supt authority to cancel, after consultation with Atty Greenspan speaks to the tour company. Seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Motion passes. Headmaster D'Alleva - just a point of information, this trip was presented in full to the school committee last year. We always purchase insurance before we approve any trip. The school committee approved the trip at the June 3, 2019 meeting. Superintendent - I did get to go to Paris my senior year so I realize the student's disappointment. We will do our due diligence and notify our state delegation about this as the entire state is affected. Mr. Ruseau - This does not affect all families equally. Some might have had to work an additional job - I wanted to note that. Ms. McLaughlin - maybe the School Committee could do a letter expressing our

disappointment to the travel agency & Delta and to ask them to help address the costs? Maybe Superintendents would be willing to come together to write letters? Harry McGillvary - This is unacceptable. Going forward maybe not using this company moving forward. Maybe get the Attorney General involved? Karla Flores, a Medford High School student- I worked extra shifts to split the cost with my parents. Some students worked to fund the trip themselves. Motion to amend and add that students sign onto the letter, says Ms. McLaughlin. Seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot - Motion passes. Ms. Graham - I make a motion to send the field trip policy to the Rules Subcommittee. Maybe it would be possible to have an insurance expert at the meeting or what if we self-insure? Seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve No School Choice District 2020-2021 - Dr. Edouard-Vincent Mr. Ruseau makes motion to approve, seconded by Ms. Mustone. Roll Call Vote - Votes (7) in affirmative, (0) in the negative, motion passes.

Report on Student Opportunity Act - Dr. Peter Cushing - Our plans are due by April 1st. Medford is receiving \$138, 660 extra . Basically the minimum per student = \$30 per student - I can not explain the formulas on these calculations. They have 37 districts that are deemed in tremendous need. Not looking for a big strategic plan. The key areas we plan to utilize are: webinar, student subgroups, continue evidenced based programs, and monitor success in reducing disparities in subgroups. We want to do a few things well. Ms. Graham - It is important to note that our charter bill will increase next year as well, so this money will not go far. Have you heard anything from our state delegation? I make a motion to send this to the Engagement Subcommittee for further work on this submission. Seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Ms. McLaughlin - By moving it to the subcommittee, it is March 9th and it is due April 1st. We have 10 days to engage the community? Is this a meaningful engagement?? Dr. Cushing - Guidance came out late by DESE Our goal is to get a survey out by Wednesday. DESE requires it to be filed by April 1st. Ms. McLaughlin - Can we ask DESE for an extension? 10 days is not meaningful engagement. Superintendent - I am not sure that is an option. I can reach out to DESE, but I do not see them approving an extension due to the small amount of money we have been allotted. It does not yield that much for us. Ms. McLaughlin - I understand, but it still needs to be a meaningful engagement. What about our marginal families? They will not be able to do it in (10) days. Mr. Ruseau - We have not been able to grab our marginal families in years here. It would take a good year to try to reach out to these families. The city and school would have to commit to this. Ms. Graham - I agree there is not enough time for any of this. Our central question must be, what is our plan for ongoing engagement? We could draft a plan? Organizations that reach our marginal community? Ms. McLaughlin - we have white engaged families making decisions for black and brown families. Who are we bringing to the table? PTO's, SEPAC, EL - how are we translating the survey? DESE did not give us enough time. This is not reasonable. Ms. Van der Kloot - I concur. It is crazy for such a quick return . We should put together a letter, indicating not enough time to engage our families. Maybe other Superintendents are having this issue as well? Yet, on the other hand, I do not want to leave money on the table. In the meantime, we should do whatever work we can do to present to DESE. Ms. McLaughlin - To those watching, please reach out to the school committee, that you want to be involved. I appreciate your work, but I feel this is an important matter. Motion by Ms. Van der Kloot to send letter, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Motion Passes.

Old Business - none

IX. Communications - none

X. New Business

1. School Safety/Procedural Update - motion to table by Ms. McLaughlin, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Motion tabled.
2. Status of Outstanding Reports - Motion to table by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Motion tabled.
3. The Function of the Medford School Committee 2020-2022 Document Update - Offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Motion tabled.
4. Be it resolved that a Playground Advisory Committee shall be created to oversee the completion of work associated with 3 CPC Grants related to the Columbus and Brooks playground repair and resurfacing, and the McGlynn school design study. The work will include collaboration and review of the RFP for the McGlynn design study and the execution of the study. The advisory committee will also view all four school playgrounds and make recommendations regarding increased accessibility of playgrounds to all our students to be completed within the existing scope of funding or provided to the School Committee as additional recommendations. The advisory committee shall provide a preliminary update to the School Committee no later than June 1st and then quarterly thereafter for up to one year from the date of creation or sooner if work is completed. **Dr. Peter Cushing will issue a call for interested applicants and recommend members for the Playground Advisory Committee to the School Committee no later than the April 6, 2020 School Committee meeting.** The Playground Advisory Committee will include school administrators, at least one parent from each elementary school, and individuals with expertise in inclusive play and play spaces. - Offered by Ms. Graham

Ms. Graham - this is a tight timeline, on Brooks and Columbus Playgrounds, as well as, for the McGlynn. In November, we will have to go back to the CPC for McGlynn. We want to engage the right firm especially for McGlynn. Community is interested, but this is a big project, so we need the right people engaged in this process. Ms. McLaughlin - this is important for the community. The McGlynn will feature the first inclusive play space for children of all abilities. We will need to address diversity for committee members and from SEPAC for this committee. Motion for approval as amended by Ms. McLaughlin, seconded by Ms. Graham. Motion passes.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of William Carrabino. Mr. Carrabino was the husband of Annmarie Carrabino, a retired Medford Public Schools secretary.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Priscilla Morse. Ms. Morse was the mother-in-law of Medford Public Schools staff member Pamela Morse and the mother of Hank Morse.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of John “Jackie” Hamilton. Mr. Hamilton was the brother of retired elementary teacher Judy Granara and the brother-in-law of former school committee member John Granara.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Shirley Van der Kloot. Ms. Van der Kloot was the mother-in-law of School Committee Member Paulette Van der Kloot.

Motion to adjourn at 9:47 PM to executive session - Motion by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Graham. Motion passes.

XI. Negotiations and Legal Matters

1. Cafeteria workers negotiation update
2. Union grievance update

Requested Reports:

Out-of-District Students Enrolled in Medford Schools (3/6/19)

CBA Requests (4/3/19)

Security Checklist Protocol (4/3/19)

Inventory of Large Equipment at All Schools (4/3/19)

Focus on K-2 (10/11/19)

Process for Onboarding New Staff (10/15/19)

Complete Financial Analysis of Before and After School Programs (11/18/19)

Complete Before and After School Budget (11/18/19)

Study: Universal After School Coverage (11/18/19)